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New California bill would send $35M to city attorneys, legal aid groups to fight Trump

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San Francisco Sen. Scott Wiener is proposing additional money for city attorneys and private legal aid organizations to combat President-elect Donald Trump's policies, on top of $25 million Gov. Gavin Newsom wants to send to the California attorney general.

Wiener introduced a bill to appropriate the money on Monday as part of a special legislative session Newsom called to prepare for the incoming Trump administration. In a social media post, Wiener said the legislation would appropriate $25 million to legal aid organizations to help people fight deportation, $10 million to city attorneys and county counsels to "defend against Trump," and $25 million to the attorney general's office to "enforce the law when Trump violates it."

* 'We will fight like hell': California lawmakers kick off special session to combat Trump

"We're in the calm before the storm and we know the hurricane force winds are about to hit from the incoming federal administration — it's time to get prepared and batten down the hatches," Senate President Pro Tem Mike McGuire, D-Geyserville, said in a statement. "This funding will help protect the people, policies, and progress of the Golden State along with our nation-leading economy."

Assembly Member Jesse Gabriel, D-Encino, introduced a similar bill in the Assembly to appropriate $25 million to the attorney general. Gabriel's bill does not include additional funding for legal aid organizations or city attorneys.

"We know from President-elect Trump's statements — and from the more than 120 lawsuits that California filed during the first Trump Administration — that we must be prepared to defend ourselves," Gabriel wrote in a statement.

Newsom has called for lawmakers to approve the attorney general funding but has not weighed in on Wiener's additional funding proposals.

The money would represent a tiny fraction of California's roughly $300 billion state budget. Newsom and lawmakers face the prospect of a tight budget year with little room for new spending, according to early projections.

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